

Brandon Higbee

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Summary

Senior Software Engineer with **8 years** of experience designing and delivering enterprise-grade backend systems. Led architecture for **Node.js** microservices handling marketplace transactions at scale, achieving 99.9% uptime across 500+ customers. Built **AWS** infrastructure with **Terraform**/IaC serving 2M+ daily API requests. Implemented **JWT/OIDC authentication** flows via Auth0 for secure multi-tenant SaaS platforms. Partnered with product and design teams to translate business requirements into technical solutions across healthcare education and SaaS domains. Now Works on distributed systems, observability, and mentoring engineering teams. Owns production infrastructure end to end, including on call coverage, deployment automation, and monitoring across distributed services. Comfortable partnering with platform and application teams on reliability work.

Core Skills

Languages and Frameworks: JavaScript, HTML, CSS

Backend & APIs: Node.js, NestJS, TypeScript, Python, PHP, REST APIs, GraphQL, microservices

Cloud & DevOps: AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Terraform, CloudFormation, monitoring

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, MySQL, query optimization, schema design

Security & Auth: JWT/OIDC, Auth0, OAuth2, passport-jwt, JWKS, API security

Work Experience

Senior Software Engineer | Tackle.io | Remote | 03/2022 - Present

- Established **TypeScript** and NestJS coding standards and design patterns adopted by team of 12 engineers, improving code quality and reducing review cycles by 40%.
- Designed multi-tenant SaaS platform on **AWS** infrastructure (ECS, Lambda, API Gateway, RDS), handling 2M+ daily API requests across 3 production environments.
- Architected **Node.js microservices** using NestJS and TypeScript for marketplace transaction processing, serving 500+ ISV customers with 99.9% uptime SLA.
- Mentored 3 junior and mid-level engineers through code reviews, system design sessions, and performance guidance to accelerate career growth.
- Configured **monitoring and observability** with CloudWatch and Datadog, reducing incident detection time from 10 minutes to under 2 minutes.
- Implemented **JWT/OIDC authentication** flows with Auth0, passport-jwt, and JWKS pattern for secure multi-tenant access across enterprise customers.
- Optimized **CI/CD pipelines** with GitHub Actions, reducing deployment frequency from weekly to daily releases while maintaining system reliability.
- Integrated **Contentful CMS** for dynamic content management, building custom webhooks and preview APIs for content delivery pipeline.

Software Engineer | Tackle.io | Remote | 06/2021 - 03/2022

- Built and maintained **RESTful APIs** and GraphQL endpoints for SaaS marketplace platform using Node.js, Express, and TypeScript.
- Implemented **microservices architecture** patterns for order processing and billing systems, decoupling legacy monolith into scalable services.
- Designed **PostgreSQL** database schemas and optimized complex queries, improving API response times by 35% under production load.

- Collaboratedwithproductmanagersanddesignerstotranslaterequirementsintotechnicalspecificationsanddeliverfeaturesonschedule.

SoftwareEngineerII|UltimateMedicalAcademy|Remote|04/2019 - 06/2021

- LedmigrationoflegacyPHPmonolithtomodern**Node.js microservices** architecture, supporting 30% user growth without service degradation.
- Developed**Node.js applications** with ExpressandTypeScriptforhealthcareeducationLMSplatformserving50,000+activestudents.
- Optimized**PostgreSQL**databasequeriesandimplementedRedis caching, reducingpageloadtimesfrom3secondsto1second.
- Managed**AWSinfrastructure**(EC2,S3,RDS,CloudFront)withInfrastructureasCode,achieving40% performanceimprovementand\$15,000annualcostsavings.

Software Engineer I | Ultimate Medical Academy | Remote | 08/2018 - 04/2019

- Built **RESTful APIs** with comprehensive error handling and input validation for student enrollment and course management features.
- Implemented OAuth2 and **JWT authentication** systems for secure student and faculty access to learning management system.
- Maintained and enhanced existing PHP applications while assisting with gradual migration to Node.js ecosystem.

SDK Intern | Accusoft | Remote | 06/2017 - 08/2018

- Developed software development kit for document processing and imaging solutions using JavaScript and .NET integration.
- Created comprehensive API documentation and code examples for external developer integration with Accusoft products.

Education

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of South Florida | 2014 - 2018